

SCREEN Holdings (7735.T): Conf. call takeaways: SPE orders still strong; production capacity/margins in focus; stay cautious relative to coverage

We held a conference call with SCREEN Holdings' IR team during the afternoon session on September 24. We summarize the key points of management's commentary within, including SPE segment demand trends and its thoughts on the earnings outlook. We believe high top-line growth is likely to continue through FY3/28, supported by strong WFE demand, but we maintain our view that SCREEN will find it difficult to expand profit margins. If order wins are in line with current forecasts, securing production capacity will also be a focus. We maintain our cautious stance relative to coverage.

Shuhei Nakamura

+81(3)4587-9932 |
shuhei.nakamura@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Kaho Otake

+81(3)4587-7498 | kaho.otake@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Demand trends in the SPE segment

SPE orders have remained at record high levels since 4Q3/26 through the current 2Q, reaching a volume that SCREEN believes can fully support 2H3/27 guidance (quarterly sales of ¥180 bn). Based on current forecasts from customers, SPE sales growth for FY3/28 could exceed that for FY3/27 (although the company noted that this is strictly a forecast and not based on official orders), and SCREEN is working to procure materials and components (lead times are becoming longer for some resin-based materials) and secure production capacity. Management expects growth in sales to China through FY3/28, although potentially not as high as sales growth to regions outside China.

Management's thoughts on earnings for FY3/27-28

Regarding SPE sales for FY3/27, a specific project for China (sales of c.¥22 bn) that had been delayed from FY3/26 is expected to be booked as sales in 2Q. In terms of full-year guidance, the company commented that there could be upside if equipment scheduled for delivery in FY3/28 were brought forward to 4Q or if post-sales revenue were stronger than expected. SCREEN is working to raise its production capacity through FY3/28 to meet robust demand, and plans to secure production capacity for SPE sales of just over ¥900 bn by the end of FY3/28 (versus annualized sales of ¥720 bn in 2H3/27) by increasing shifts, changing the layout/improving production efficiency at the Hikone plant, and utilizing the facilities of subsidiaries/group companies in Kyoto.

Management's thoughts on profitability and direction of the medium-term plan

Regarding SPE product prices, SCREEN plans to continue 1) passing on higher

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material/component costs, and 2) setting prices that reflect added value through product enhancements and new product launches. In addition, the company will proceed with initiatives to raise profitability by increasing production efficiency and strengthening product competitiveness, and shared the view that a level of c.30% for SPE segment OPM serves as a benchmark level to aim for in future medium-term plans and elsewhere. SCREEN's next medium-term plan is due to be announced in May 2027, but an IR Day is scheduled for the end of March as an event to explain the direction of various strategies.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - SCREEN Holdings

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥12,800 is based on our FY3/28E earnings estimates and an 18X EV/EBITDA multiple derived from the global SPE sector average, to which we then apply a sector-relative discount of 40% to reflect recent valuation trends and uncertainty around SCREEN's China business (implies an FY3/28E P/E of 17X and a P/B of 3.6X).

Key risks: Higher profit margins in the SPE business, market share gains due to company-specific factors, enhancement of shareholder returns, a market shift in favor of value stocks.

7735.T	12m Price Target: ¥12,800	Price: ¥13,305	Downside: 3.8%
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Sell		GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥2.5tr / \$15.9bn Enterprise value: ¥2.3tr / \$14.5bn 3m ADTV: ¥44.8bn / \$279.3mn Japan Japan Semiconductor, SPE & Precision M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No			3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
		Revenue (¥ bn)	605.7	753.8	943.5	1,130.5
		Op. profit (¥ bn)	122.5	159.1	199.2	251.0
		Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	—	156.5	—	—
		EPS (¥)	486.6	616.1	758.4	953.5
		P/E (X)	14.1	21.6	17.5	14.0
		P/B (X)	2.7	4.4	3.8	3.2
		Dividend yield (%)	2.1	1.4	1.7	2.1
		N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.6)	(1.3)	(1.1)	(1.0)
		CROCI (%)	26.8	33.3	32.7	33.7
			6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)		55.5	155.1	181.8	223.8	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Contributing Authors: Shuhei Nakamura Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Kaho Otake Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd..

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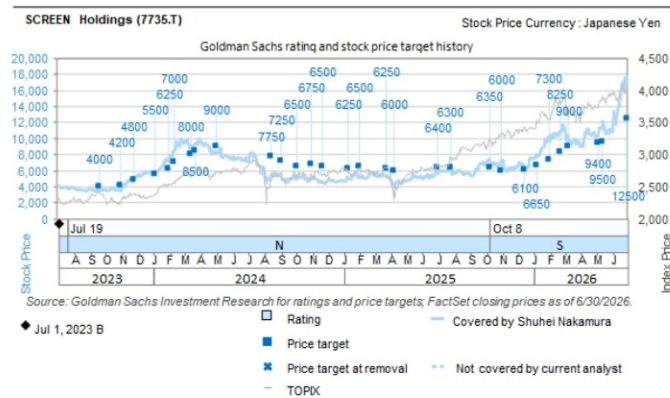
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Target price history table(s)

SCREEN Holdings (7735.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
23-Aug-26	12,800	12,970
30-Jun-26	12,500	17,805
13-May-26	9,500	11,215
04-May-26	9,400	10,390
09-Mar-26	18,000	9,515
21-Feb-26	16,500	10,990
30-Jan-26	14,600	9,830
06-Jan-26	13,300	8,035
15-Dec-25	12,200	6,570
31-Oct-25	12,000	7,343
08-Oct-25	12,700	7,333
25-Jul-25	12,600	6,110
30-Jun-25	12,800	5,880
07-Apr-25	12,000	3,954
24-Mar-25	12,500	5,240
31-Jan-25	13,000	5,463
10-Jan-25	12,500	5,040
21-Nov-24	13,000	4,549
31-Oct-24	13,500	5,015
02-Oct-24	13,000	4,956
02-Sep-24	14,500	5,305
15-Aug-24	15,500	5,523
02-May-24	18,000	8,320
21-Mar-24	17,000	9,445
13-Mar-24	16,000	9,043
09-Feb-24	14,000	8,570
31-Jan-24	12,500	7,335
04-Jan-24	11,000	5,855
25-Nov-23	9,600	5,168
31-Oct-23	8,400	3,467

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